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10616/2/39/51

BRITISH EMBASSY,

Washington, D.C.

27th December 1951.

FJ 10310/3

Dear John,

John Allison called me this morning and told me that he had just had a long conversation with Dulles. He said that although they were not able to go very much into the substance of the problem of Japan's future relations with China one point had emerged which he would like to let me know about informally at once. Both the State Department, and he gathered also the Foreign Office, had gained the impression that the memorandum prepared in Tokyo by Dulles (please see Tokyo telegram to F.O. No. 1767) was more of a formal document than it in fact had been. Dulles had discussed his views in general terms with Bill Dening. Before he saw Yoshida he had thought it safer to write down the points he intended to make so as to avoid any possibility of a misunderstanding. He had then read from the document to Yoshida. Very shortly thereafter he had shown Dening the same document. The document was, however, in no sense a formal communication to the Japanese Government and no copy had been left with Yoshida. It was merely a paper from which Dulles had talked.

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2. The above does not seem to change the substance of the position in any way. But since Allison went to the trouble of explaining the position to me in some detail over the telephone I had better pass it on for what it is worth.

3. I am sending a copy of this letter to Bill Dening.

Yours ever

Tommy

F. S. Tomlinson

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The American show a tendency to soft pedal.

B 31/XII

M: R.A. Scott

✓ HS

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